

THE SOCIAL UNIVERSE (TSU)

Core Cast Character Bible

Status: Locked. This is the founding generation — the seven who will go on to found TSU's major platforms. Platform assignments TBD in a later pass.

All characters are African American, working within a real, diverse entertainment industry (i.e. the industry itself is depicted as it actually exists — this cast is simply the Black core of it, not the whole of it). Ages as of 2004: early-to-mid twenties, which is exactly the right age for the platform-founder archetype (Zuckerberg was 19, Ev Williams was early 30s, Kevin Systrom was 26) — but this crew also carries 15-20 years of industry mileage from being child stars, which is the twist: they're not garage-dwelling college dropouts, they're already famous when they start building.

MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK

Born: January 5, 1982 (Capricorn) — Los Angeles, CA **Family:** Second child, oldest son of Natasha Bullock (née Donohue) and Robert Bullock. Grandson of Victor and Joan Donohue.

The Career Marc-Anthony is a former Disney Channel/Nickelodeon dual-network child star — a rare feat, since the two networks rarely shared talent, but he was good enough and likable enough that both wanted him simultaneously in the mid-90s. By 2004 he's transitioning into adult work: acclaimed, awarded, bankable, and a working recording artist and producer on top of acting. He's the industry's golden child in the most literal sense — three generations of Hollywood royalty behind him (his grandfather Victor Donohue is a billionaire screen legend, his parents are a powerhouse director/actress pair), and he's never once embarrassed the family name.

The Person Where he separates from every "gifted rich kid" cliché is that he's disarmingly, almost inconveniently kind. Not performatively humble — genuinely soft-hearted, the guy who remembers your birthday, who tips absurdly, who will stop an interview to help a crying kid find their parents. He pairs that with a mind that moves faster than the room around him — a reported IQ in the 200s, the kind of number that gets whispered about more than confirmed, because he never leads with it. He doesn't need to. People clock it in the first five minutes of a conversation. He's magnetic on camera in the way certain people just *are*, but off camera he's the friend who organizes the group chat, remembers everyone's coffee order, and cries at his own nieces' dance recitals.

He's also, in total contrast to the sweetness, one of the funniest people alive in private — fully unhinged, un-PC, roast-your-friends-until-they-cry funny, a completely different register than his public-facing warmth. The people who work with him describe it as "get him with the right five people in a room and he becomes a different, more dangerous animal." It's the kind of duality that makes him magnetic to write — Mr. Rogers by day, insult comic at 1am.

The Dream Underneath the résumé, the one thing Marc-Anthony wants more than any award is a family — not eventually, not "if it happens," but as a stated, non-negotiable life goal. He wants a big family, kids specifically, and he thinks in terms of generational wealth the way other moguls think in terms of quarterly earnings — money as something you build to hand down, not to spend. It's the throughline that makes

his eventual platform-founding make sense thematically: everything he builds, he's building for people who don't exist yet.

The Complication He hasn't had his "adult" breakout role yet — the one that proves he's not just "that kid from Disney" forever. He's aware of the clock. Everyone in the industry is watching to see if he can pull off the transition the way very few child stars ever do.

The Soulmate Esther Smiley. They've known each other since childhood — friends first, on-and-off in each other's orbit for two decades — and don't actually get together romantically until 2011. Married 2013. Everyone who knows them has been waiting for it since they were teenagers; they're the last two people to figure it out.

AMOND BAKER

Born: February 10, 1982 — Los Angeles, CA

The Career Marc-Anthony's best friend since they were kids on set together — not a manufactured industry friendship, an actual brotherhood, the kind where they've been in each other's family homes since before either of them could drive. Amond is also a former child actor and singer, and where Marc-Anthony is the golden child of a Hollywood dynasty, Amond is the guy who came up through pure talent and grit alongside him — the friend who was there before any of it was guaranteed.

The Person Steadier than Marc-Anthony, more guarded, the "right hand man" energy that comes from being genuinely loyal rather than genuinely famous. Where Marc-Anthony is the visionary who thinks in decades, Amond is the executor — the one who actually makes sure the plan happens. He's protective of Marc-Anthony almost like an older brother despite being the younger one by a month, quick to shut down anyone who tries to get close to Marc for the wrong reasons.

The Complication His career has cooled. He's not struggling, exactly, but he's in the industry's most dangerous zone for a former child star: old enough that "promising young talent" doesn't apply anymore, not yet proven enough in adult roles to be considered a serious leading man. Casting directors keep offering him the same "charming best friend" part in different clothes. He knows it. It eats at him more than he lets on, especially standing next to Marc-Anthony's trajectory.

The Love Story Harmony Divine. They don't get together until 2013, married 2015 — the slow-burn of the group, the two who circle each other for a decade before either says anything.

TYRESE AVERY

Born: July 24, 1981 — the elder statesman of the group by a year

The Career The odd one out by profession — not an actor, a full-blown global pop star, already superstar-level famous by 2004 in a way that operates on a different axis than the rest of the group's industry. He's the one who's played arenas, who has the kind of fame where strangers already know the sound of his voice before they know his face.

The Role in the Group Tyrese functions as the crew's outside perspective — he's adjacent to the acting world through friendship, not competing in it, which makes him the one who can see the industry's shape from a slight distance. That distance is exactly what makes him valuable later: he's thinking about

audience and fandom and distribution at a scale the actors, focused on roles and reviews, aren't yet.

The Relationship Dr. Simone Kester. Unlike the other six, Tyrese had no locked romantic timeline in the original source material — this one originates in `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md` rather than working around a pre-set future date. She runs a small contract-engineering shop in Atlanta and, notably, is the first person in years to have no interest whatsoever in who he is or was.

ESTHER SMILLEY (later Bullock)

Born: September 20, 1982 — Los Angeles, CA

The Career A former child actress with the kind of career trajectory press loves to compare to old Hollywood — she's been called "a modern-day Shirley Temple" so many times it's become shorthand in profiles of her. Award-winning, respected, and unlike a lot of her peers, she made the transition into more serious adult work relatively gracefully, though she still fights the "America's sweetheart" box the press built for her as a kid.

The Person Elegant in a way that reads effortless because it's not performed — she's the person in every room who makes other people want to be better versions of themselves without ever saying a word about it. She's also sharper than her public image gives her credit for; the "sweetheart" branding undersells a genuinely shrewd business mind, which becomes relevant fast once this group starts building companies.

The Complication The Shirley Temple comparison is a compliment that's becoming a cage. She's fighting to be taken seriously as an adult performer and not just "the girl who was adorable in 1990" — a specific, well-documented Hollywood trap for former child stars, especially women.

The Soulmate Marc-Anthony Bullock. Best friends for most of their lives before either admits there's more there — together 2011, married 2013.

ARIANNA CUMMINGS

Born: October 25, 1982 — Los Angeles, CA

The Career Arianna was never a child star — she's the only member of the core seven who came up the "normal" way, through theater training and open-call auditions rather than being discovered as a kid. That distinction matters to her more than she usually admits: she watched the rest of the group get handed a foothold in the industry before puberty, while she was still doing regional theater and background work in her late teens. By 2004 she's twenty-two, classically trained, and has built a résumé that impresses casting directors in the room and means nothing to anyone outside it — a string of respected supporting turns in projects that didn't land, two pilots that got cancelled after a handful of episodes, and one leading role in an indie film that premiered at a festival to real acclaim and then never found distribution. She has, on paper, "almost" happened to her three separate times. Industry people who've worked with her will tell you, unprompted, that she's the most talented person in whatever room she's in. It hasn't translated to the public knowing her name.

The Person Arianna is the sharpest read on the industry in the entire friend group, precisely because she's had to survive in it without a safety net. She's watchful in rooms — not guarded exactly, but she

clocks who's actually paying attention to her and who's being polite to her because of who she's friends with, and she can tell the difference instantly. She has a dry, understated sense of humor that catches people off guard because she's quiet until she isn't. She's fiercely loyal to the group and has never once let her own stalled career curdle into resentment toward the friends who broke through faster — but she's also the one who, in private, will say the thing everyone else is too polite to say about how unfair the business actually is.

The Complication The "hasn't broken through yet" isn't abstract — it has a shape. She's watched three different projects almost be the one: the acclaimed indie with no distributor, the pilot that got cancelled after four episodes, the studio role she tested for twice and lost to someone with a bigger Instagram following before Instagram even fully existed yet — an early, personal taste of exactly the kind of gatekeeping that platforms will later blow open. That specific irony — losing a role to someone with more *followers* in an era before "followers" meant anything yet — is her origin wound, and it's the single most direct throughline from any character in the cast to *why* she'd want to build a platform instead of waiting for Hollywood's permission.

The Relationship Malcolm Pierce. Like Tyrese, Arianna had no locked romantic timeline in the original source material — this one originates in `scripts/THE_FRAME.md`. A documentary photographer with no following of his own and a genuine eye, he's the first person to see her clearly rather than politely.

HARMONY DIVINE (later Baker)

Born: June 19, 1982 — Los Angeles, CA

The Career Came up primarily as a dancer, with a Broadway pedigree, before fully crossing over into acting. Award-winning now in her acting work, but she carries a dancer's discipline into everything she does — she's the most rigorously trained performer in the group in the traditional sense, formal technique where a lot of her peers came up purely on camera instinct.

The Person Precise, disciplined, a perfectionist in the specific way dancers often are — she thinks in counts and rehearsal, prepares obsessively, and has very little patience for people who coast on talent alone. That precision reads as poise publicly and as exacting privately; she's the friend who notices the detail everyone else missed.

The Love Story Amond Baker. A slow circle for a decade — together 2013, married 2015. She's Marc-Anthony's future goddaughter's mother, tying the two households together even before the marriages happen.

TYLER CHAPMAN

Born: January 4, 1982 — Los Angeles, CA

The Career Tyler is the group's rarest kind of working actor: the guy who's in everything and famous for none of it individually. He came up as a teen through a mid-tier UPN/WB sitcom that ran four seasons and was beloved by the people who watched it without ever being a genuine cultural moment — the kind of show that gives you a devoted, specific fanbase and zero mainstream household-name recognition. Since it ended he's built a real career: supporting roles in studio films, a recurring part on a procedural, session and feature work as a musician, a writing credit or two he doesn't talk about much because he's

shy about the writing specifically. He works constantly. Ask the average person on the street to name him and they can't; ask anyone who's actually worked in film or TV in the last decade and they light up.

The Person Tyler is the connective tissue of the friend group in a different way than Amond — where Amond is Marc-Anthony's specific right hand, Tyler is a floater, close with everyone individually, the person who keeps the wider circle actually functioning as a group rather than just several pairs of best friends. He's easygoing to the point that people sometimes underestimate how much he notices; he's the one who remembers the fight two people had eight months ago that they've both pretended to forget, and who quietly smooths things over before anyone else even registers there was friction. Musically he's more serious than his acting career suggests — it's genuinely his first love, acting came second and pays better, and there's a real tension in him between the two that he's never fully resolved.

The Complication Tyler's issue isn't a dry spell, exactly — it's a ceiling. He's extremely good at being the reliable "and also starring" name in the credits, and Hollywood has quietly decided that's what he is, permanently. He's never been fired, never bombed, never had the embarrassing flop — he's also never been the reason anyone bought a ticket. It's a gentler complication than Amond's typecasting or Arianna's total lack of a break, but it's its own kind of trap: he's successful enough that nobody around him worries about him, which means nobody's pushing him to want more than "reliably employed." Privately, the music is where his actual hunger lives — he's aware that if he doesn't make a real bid for something bigger soon, "dependable supporting guy" becomes his whole ceiling rather than a stepping stone.

GROUP DYNAMICS AT A GLANCE

Pairing	Status in 2004	Locked-in Future
Marc-Anthony & Esther	Close friends, unspoken chemistry	Together 2011, married 2013
Amond & Harmony	Circling each other, unspoken	Together 2013, married 2015
Marc-Anthony & Amond	Brothers since childhood	Lifelong
Tyrese	Outside-industry perspective, pop superstar	The group's "wide lens"
Arianna	Hungriest, three near-misses, no break yet	Most to prove
Tyler	Group glue, "reliable" ceiling, secretly hungrier for music than acting	Steady presence with hidden ambition

Why this cast works as platform founders: every one of them has a different relationship to fame and the industry's gatekeeping — a dynasty kid, a loyal best friend stuck in typecasting, an outsider pop star, a "sweetheart" fighting to be taken seriously, an underdog who's lost roles to people with bigger followings before "followers" meant anything, a disciplined perfectionist, and a beloved-but-capped connector who's never been pushed to want more. That's seven distinct *reasons* to want to build

something outside the traditional Hollywood machine — which is exactly the emotional logic real platform founders needed (Zuckerberg's outsider-at-Harvard chip on his shoulder, Systrom's "photography for everyone" idealism). Each of these seven already has their motive built in before we even assign them a platform. Notably, Arianna's origin wound — losing a role to someone with a bigger following — and Tyler's "capped but hungry" arc are the two most literal, ready-made reasons in the group to want to build the exact kind of platform that lets talent bypass gatekeepers entirely.

Doc status: Locked per user instruction. Platform assignments to be determined in a future pass.